



THE WRHINOS FRAMEWORK

Freedom through Responsibility. Adventure through Community.

Parts I – V

The Spirit of the Community · The Ride Charter · Ride Standards
The Trip Guide · Governance and Stewardship

VERSION 2.0

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Part I — The Spirit of the Community

Why We Exist

Every community should be able to say why it exists before it explains what it does.

We exist because travelling by bicycle changes people.

A bike moves at a human pace. It takes you down roads a car would never turn into, past places you would otherwise pass at seventy, and into conversations you would never otherwise have. But the best journeys aren't measured by where they took us. They're measured by who we became on the way.

So this is not a tour operator. We organise rides, but organising rides is the method, not the point. The point is what happens to people on them: the confidence someone finds on their first multi-day ride, the encouragement offered before it's asked for, the friendships that outlast the trip by years, and the rider who comes back the following season not for another trip but to help someone else have theirs.

We welcome riders of every background, ability and level of experience. Everyone arrives with something to gain and something to give — often on the same day, usually without noticing.

Our ambition reaches beyond any single ride, any year's calendar, or any of us currently in it. We want a community that grows stronger with every trip and keeps going long after today's riders have hung up their wheels: where knowledge is shared freely, newcomers are welcomed warmly, experienced riders stay lifelong learners, and the next generation of organisers emerges through service and example rather than appointment. A community that doesn't depend on any one person.

If, in years to come, people say not only that they had remarkable rides but that this community made them more confident, more thoughtful, more generous and more adventurous, we will have done what we set out to do.

The ambition was never to run exceptional cycling trips. It was always to build an exceptional community through them.

Our Ethos

Freedom through Responsibility. Adventure through Community.

Six words. Everything else in this Framework grows out of them.

Freedom through Responsibility

The best trips give people room — to explore, to push themselves, to ride the day their own way.

That freedom isn't created by removing responsibility. It's created because responsibility is shared. When people prepare properly, make informed decisions and take ownership of their own participation, the need for rules falls away, trust grows, and everyone gets more room to move.

Responsibility isn't a burden placed on riders. It's what buys the freedom.

The more each of us accepts, the more all of us enjoy.

Adventure through Community

Trip is rarely a solo achievement. The journeys we remember are shaped less by the roads than by the people we rode them with.

No organiser can manufacture that atmosphere. It appears on its own when people celebrate each other's efforts, offer help before being asked, and recognise that everyone has something worth contributing.

The strongest communities aren't built by travelling together. They're built by growing together.

How We Live It

Values are shown in choices, not statements. These six describe the character we're aiming for — and what each one actually looks like on the road.

Trip

Exploring new places and stepping past our comfort zones makes life bigger. Trip isn't measured in distance, speed or elevation; it's found in curiosity and the willingness to meet the unfamiliar.

We design rides to challenge people, not to sort them into fast and slow.

Community

Every good trip is a partnership. Those organising it plan carefully, communicate clearly and provide sensible support. Those riding it prepare thoroughly, engage with what's been sent and contribute to the mood of the group.

Neither half works without the other: planning can't rescue poor preparation, and enthusiasm can't substitute for it.

We join as contributors, not as customers.

Responsibility

We prepare, navigate, manage our own kit, and deal with the routine problems a day on the bike produces. We ask for help when we genuinely need it and offer it when someone else does.

We also read what's been sent before asking for it again — not because questions are unwelcome, but because somebody spent their evenings writing it.

Self-sufficiency is not isolation. It's simply what makes the whole thing work for everyone.

Growth

Everyone starts somewhere, and every ride is a chance to be better than you were before it.

Growth isn't measured in watts. It shows up as judgement, resilience, adaptability and generosity — the quiet confidence of someone who knows what they're doing.

It doesn't stop when you become a strong rider, either. At that point it turns into a responsibility to bring others along.

Stewardship

Nobody owns this community. We're all temporary custodians of something meant to outlast us.

Stewardship means sharing knowledge generously, welcoming newcomers warmly, and preparing the people who will run this after we've stopped.

Humility

Trip has a reliable way of reminding us that none of us has all the answers, usually somewhere near the top of a climb we'd described as fine.

We value listening as much as leading. Leadership here is service, not rank: reassuring a nervous rider, sharing what you know, quietly solving a problem without waiting for credit.

Leadership isn't a position anyone holds. It's a responsibility anyone can pick up.

When in Doubt

No document anticipates everything. When a decision isn't covered here, five questions usually settle it:

- Does it reflect why we exist?
- Is it consistent with our ethos?
- Does it uphold our values?
- Does it strengthen the community?
- Will it leave things better than we found them?

Yes to those, and you're probably on the right road.

Values only mean anything when they show up in behaviour. Every rider shapes the culture and every decision strengthens or weakens it. That is what turns this from words on a page into the character of the community itself.

Part II — The Ride Charter

Introduction

The Charter is the promise we make to one another whenever we travel together.

It isn't a rulebook. Routes, destinations and conditions change from ride to ride, and the practical requirements for each one are set out in its Trip Guide. The Charter describes something more durable: the spirit we ride in, and what we owe ourselves, each other and the places we pass through.

It applies to everyone on the trip — riders, non-riders, volunteers, support crew, planners and anyone taking a leadership role. Different people carry different responsibilities. No role puts anyone above the Charter.

Joining a ride means joining a shared undertaking rather than attending something arranged by other people. Those organising will bring careful planning, clear communication and sensible support. Everyone else brings preparation, judgement, good humour and ownership of their own day.

Eight commitments follow.

One — We create the trip together

The route may be planned by someone else. The ride isn't.

Its character comes from everyone on it: from how we prepare, how we behave, and what we bring to the group. Some lead, some support, some bring knowledge, some bring energy and encouragement. Every version counts.

We join as contributors, not as customers.

Two — We take responsibility for our participation

We decide honestly whether a ride suits us, and prepare for what it actually asks. We turn up with the right bike, kit, documents and insurance.

On the road we ride within our capabilities and say something early when circumstances change.

Responsibility doesn't mean handling every difficulty alone. It means knowing which difficulties are ours, which need help, and which affect everybody else.

Three — We prepare and remain informed

Preparation starts long before day one. We read what's sent, turn up to the briefings, and get familiar with the route, the kit list and the conditions we're heading into.

Questions are always welcome when something is genuinely unclear — after a look at what's already been shared. Somebody wrote all of it, in their own time.

Preparing well means the group's attention stays free for the problems nobody could have predicted.

Four — We develop self-sufficiency and sound judgement

We learn to navigate using whatever system the ride runs on, look after our own bike and kit, carry what we need, and deal with the ordinary problems of a long day.

We don't ride blindly behind the wheel in front. Groups split, and the rider ahead may be just as lost.

Judgement also means recognising when conditions have changed, when to ask for help, and when carrying on is no longer the sensible choice. The point isn't independence for its own sake. It's being capable enough to go further with less fuss.

Five — We support one another

We look out for each other, share what we know, and offer help that builds confidence rather than dependence.

Success looks different for each of us: the full route for one, a hard climb attempted for another, a sensible decision to stop for a third. We don't measure everyone against the same yardstick.

Support doesn't mean removing the challenge. It means nobody meets a difficult moment without encouragement, dignity or a hand if they need one.

We ride at different speeds and different distances. We don't leave each other behind in spirit.

Six — We treat people and places with respect

Courtesy, patience and dignity — for fellow riders, volunteers, support crews, hosts and everyone we meet along the way.

Disagreements happen, especially when people are tired, wet or several hours behind schedule. We raise them calmly and directly, and aim at the problem rather than the person.

We are guests. We follow local laws and customs, look after the environment, and try to leave every village with a better opinion of cyclists than it had before we arrived.

Seven — We put safety before pride

We take risk thoughtfully rather than recklessly, and respond sensibly to traffic, terrain, weather, fatigue and illness.

No distance, climb, timetable or personal ambition matters more than someone's wellbeing. Slowing down, shortening the day, taking the van or stopping altogether is never failure.

We say when something is wrong instead of hiding pain, exhaustion or fear of being an inconvenience.

Courage isn't ignoring danger. It's making a sound decision when things get difficult.

Eight — We learn, contribute and leave the community stronger

Every trip teaches something. We reflect honestly on what worked and what didn't, offer feedback constructively and receive it with humility.

As experience grows, we pass it on. Some go on to mentor, lead or organise. Others contribute in quieter ways. What matters is the willingness to give something back.

The aim is simple: leave every ride, every rider and the community itself a little stronger than we found them.

Our Shared Commitment

By joining a trip, we commit to the spirit of this Charter:

We will prepare thoughtfully and stay informed.

We will take responsibility for our choices, conduct and contribution.

We will build the skills and judgement to ride with confidence and increasing self-sufficiency.

We will support one another with patience, generosity and respect.

We will value every ability, every level of experience and every form of achievement.

We will treat the people and places we meet with dignity and care.

We will put safety and wellbeing before pride, distance or ambition.

We will reflect honestly, share what we learn, and strengthen the community for those who follow.

Above all: a trip isn't something created for us.

It's something we create, together.

Freedom through Responsibility. Adventure through Community.

Part III — Ride Standards

Introduction

Standards turn our commitments into consistent practice.

They sit between the Charter and the ride itself. The Charter says what we promise each other. The Trip Guide for each trip says what that particular journey requires. These Standards describe what good planning, preparation, participation and conduct look like across all of them.

They don't prescribe operational detail. Destinations differ in terrain, culture, climate, risk and logistics, and each ride's Trip Guide handles the specifics. They apply to everyone involved: planners, riders, non-riders, volunteers, support crew and anyone taking a leadership role.

The aim isn't uniformity. It's consistency of principle.

Standard One — The Nature of Our Rides

Our rides are shared trips, not commercial tours. They're built by members of the community giving their time and experience. We may pay for transport, accommodation, guiding or mechanical support, but the trip itself stays a community undertaking.

Trip, not a packaged holiday

Routes change. Weather intervenes. Transport runs late, kit breaks, and people adapt their day. Careful planning removes the avoidable problems; it cannot remove difficulty, and it isn't meant to. Come with realistic expectations and a willingness to roll with it.

Challenge with choice

Rides should offer meaningful challenge without requiring everyone to complete every kilometre. That means shorter distances, alternative starting points, optional climbs, vehicle support and non-riding activities wherever the route allows. Taking one of those options is not failure — it's the design working.

Participation, not competition

Unless a ride is explicitly described otherwise, it isn't a race. Speed, distance and climbing are personal achievements, not standing within the community. Achievement takes many forms: finishing the route, attempting a hard section, deciding wisely to stop, or looking after someone else all day.

This is also an insurance condition. Our affiliation cover excludes competitive cycling, so no trip may be run as a race, time trial or mass-start event.

Freedom within a shared structure

Ride at your own pace, stop for photographs, explore what catches your eye. That freedom sits inside an agreed structure: follow the route, observe start and finish arrangements, stay contactable, and tell someone about any decision that affects the group or the support team.

We ride different distances at different speeds. We make the journey together.

Standard Two — Participation Standards

Participation brings both opportunity and responsibility. These standards exist to help people make informed and honest decisions, not to keep anyone out.

Informed participation

Before committing to a ride, you should have:

- Destination and duration
- Expected distances and climbing
- Terrain and road conditions
- Climate and likely weather
- The level of support available
- How much flexibility the route allows
- Any significant limitations, uncertainties or risks

Read it, and ask about anything important that stays unclear. Joining a ride is an informed choice.

Honest self-assessment

Consider your health, fitness, experience, confidence and circumstances honestly. Not everyone needs to be capable of every kilometre — but everyone needs to be able to take part safely within the options and support described. Raise any uncertainty early. This isn't a test of worth; it's what lets sensible decisions get made in good time.

Younger riders

We welcome riders from the age of ten.

Every rider under 18 must be accompanied by a parent, or by an adult the parents have named in writing before the ride. That adult holds responsibility for them throughout — on the bike, at the accommodation, and everywhere in between.

This is a parent-accompanied community, not a supervised youth activity. Organisers, volunteers and support crew are not responsible for looking after anyone's children, and nobody should plan on the assumption that they are.

The accompanying adult takes on:

- Riding with the young rider, or agreeing explicitly beforehand where they will be if not
- Judging honestly whether the route, distance, traffic and conditions suit that rider
- Authority to consent to medical treatment, held in writing from the parents if the adult is not one
- Accommodation, meals and evenings

Ten is a floor, not a guarantee. A young rider may be entirely at home on a flat family route and well out of their depth on an Alpine descent in traffic. The usual honest conversation about options and support applies, with the parent in it.

The freedom to ride your own day, set out in Standard Five, does not extend to leaving a young rider unaccompanied.

For overseas trips, a young rider travelling without both parents should carry a written consent letter. Some countries require it at the border rather than merely preferring it.

Different forms of participation

You might complete the full route, ride selected stages, take shorter options, join as a non-rider, or contribute through logistics, photography, driving or encouragement. These are different, not lesser.

Inclusion doesn't mean every ride suits every person. It means the options are described honestly and every contribution is respected.

Health and personal information

Tell us about any health condition, injury, medication or personal circumstance that could materially affect your safe participation or the support you might need. A health condition doesn't bar anyone from riding — disclosure exists so planning can be proportionate, not so people can be excluded.

Because this is sensitive information, we handle it to a clear standard:

- **We collect the minimum.** Only what materially affects safe participation or the support you might need — not a medical history.
- **You carry your own card.** Every rider carries emergency contact details, relevant conditions, medication and allergies on their person, in a jersey pocket or bar bag. In an emergency this is what actually helps, and it keeps the information with the person it belongs to.
- **One named holder.** The Ride Coordinator holds the file for the trip, in an access-controlled document. Not a group chat, not a shared spreadsheet, not a printout in the van.

- **Deleted within 30 days of return**, unless an incident has occurred that requires a record to be kept.

Changing or ending participation

Circumstances change. Illness, injury, fatigue or life may mean shortening a stage, taking support, or stopping altogether. Communicate promptly; none of it is failure, and it's often the most responsible call available.

Occasionally, participation may need to be restricted or ended by the community rather than the rider. There are two distinct situations, and they are handled differently.

Immediate safety, during a trip. The Ride Coordinator may restrict or end an individual's participation where there is an immediate concern for their safety or the safety of others. Such a decision takes effect at once and is not open to challenge in the moment. It should be explained as soon as circumstances allow.

Conduct, or exclusion from future trips. This is not one person's decision. It is taken by three members of the community, at least one of whom had no involvement in the events concerned. The person is told what is alleged and given the opportunity to respond before any decision is made, and the decision and its reasons are recorded in writing.

Any such decision must be proportionate, driven by conduct and risk rather than personality, popularity or standing, and guided by wellbeing rather than punishment.

The participation standard

Responsible participation begins with an informed choice. It requires honesty about suitability, openness about relevant concerns, and a willingness to adapt when circumstances change.

Participation isn't defined by how far you ride. It's defined by taking part responsibly, safely, and as a valued member of the community.

Standard Three — Planning Standards

Good trips start with thoughtful planning: a clear, realistic and flexible framework people can prepare against.

A clear purpose

Every ride should begin with a clear sense of what it's for — physical challenge, exploration, culture, friendship, a charitable aim, or a balance of several. That purpose shapes the route, pace, accommodation and support. A ride shouldn't become harder, pricier or more complicated than its purpose requires.

Realistic design

Plan on more than distance: terrain, climbing, road surfaces, weather, daylight, consecutive riding days, transfers and recovery. Published plans must reflect the likely experience of the group rather than the strongest riders on a perfect day.

Ambition inspires the trip. Realism shapes it.

Flexibility by design

Shorter stages, alternative starts, optional climbs, vehicle support and rest options belong in the plan from the beginning, not bolted on once someone is struggling. Explain clearly what's available and how it works.

Inclusion without misrepresentation

Suitability is settled by open discussion between the rider and those running the ride: the rider gives an honest account of their ability, health and needs; the organisers judge what can be accommodated safely within the route and resources available. Specialist advice should inform that where relevant.

Inclusion must never depend on understating difficulty, glossing over risk, or promising support that can't reliably be delivered. Not every ride suits every person, and saying so plainly is kinder than the alternative.

Proportionate support

Support should match the environment. Remote or demanding journeys may need professional mechanical, medical or logistical cover; simpler ones need much less. Support exists to make the trip possible and answer genuine need — not to replace preparation and judgement.

Clear responsibilities

Every trip has a named **Ride Coordinator** and a named **Deputy**, both identified in the Trip Guide before departure. The Deputy acts whenever the Coordinator is unavailable, and in any matter concerning the Coordinator personally.

Beyond those two roles, it should be clear before a ride begins who holds routes, communication, transport, accommodation, finances, support arrangements and emergency decisions. Roles needn't be formal, but essential tasks shouldn't rest on assumption or land on one person by default. Clarity protects volunteers as much as it protects riders.

Planning should also settle, for any trip where e-bikes are expected, how batteries will be transported and where they will be charged.

Clear and timely information

Information should be clear, easy to find, issued at the right time and updated when things change. Mark provisional information as provisional, and make any action required of riders explicit. Volume isn't the goal; sufficiency is.

Money

Our trips run at cost. Nobody profits from them, and no surplus is distributed to anyone.

How the money moves. Each trip is funded in advance by the organiser, who books and pays the suppliers, keeps the accounts and reconciles the trip at the end. Riders pay:

- A **non-refundable deposit** on booking, set at a nominal level, used to secure arrangements.
- **Interim payments**, called only where a supplier requires funds before departure, with the reason stated.
- A **final balance** after the trip, once every cost has been paid and the accounts reconciled.

Billing after the event rather than estimating beforehand means riders pay what the trip actually cost. No padding, no built-in contingency, no surplus anyone has to argue about afterwards.

The administration fee. A flat fee of £50 per rider is added to each trip and donated in full to charity. The recipient is chosen by the riders: suggestions are invited during the trip and a consensus reached. The fee is retained neither by the organiser nor by the community.

Funding and card benefits. Trip expenditure is placed on the organiser's personal credit card so that suppliers can be paid in advance, and is reimbursed at cost from the community's account against invoices, approved by a signatory other than the person reimbursed. Any loyalty or reward benefits arising accrue to the funding member, in recognition of the personal financial risk carried on the community's behalf. We state this openly because transparency matters to us more than the sum involved does.

Where funds are held. Riders transfer their payments to an account held in the name of WRhinos and operated by two signatories. All suppliers are paid from that account, and each trip is reconciled against it.

What the cost includes. Every Trip Guide sets out what is covered and what isn't. Where a professional support team is engaged, its full cost is carried by the trip. Where volunteers provide support, they fund their own travel while their accommodation and meals during the support period are shared across the riders. Both appear in the cost breakdown, so nobody is quietly paying for something they didn't know about.

Travel is arranged by riders. Riders book and pay for their own travel to and from the trip. The community does not book flights or sell travel on anyone's behalf.

If a rider withdraws. The deposit is not refunded. Beyond that, riders remain responsible for costs already committed on their behalf that cannot be

recovered from suppliers. We will always try to recover or re-let whatever we can.

If a trip is cancelled. Where the community cancels, riders receive back everything recoverable from suppliers. Unrecoverable costs are shared between those booked. We say this in advance so nobody meets it as a surprise, and it is why personal travel insurance is a requirement rather than a suggestion.

Unpaid balances. Billing in arrears depends on trust, and so far that trust has never been misplaced. Should a final balance go unpaid, it remains due to the community, and a rider with an outstanding balance will not join a further trip until it is settled.

The status of these arrangements. Our trips are organised occasionally, on a not-for-profit basis, for a limited group of members. They are not commercial holidays and are not sold to the public. On that basis they fall outside the Package Travel and Linked Travel Arrangements Regulations 2018 — which means riders do **not** have the insolvency protection or the statutory rights that apply to a package bought from a tour operator. Please understand this before booking, and insure yourself accordingly.

Contingency

Weather, roads, transport, accommodation, illness or local events may force changes. Not every possibility needs a documented alternative, but the ride should keep enough slack for sensible decisions to be made when reality diverges from the plan.

Respect for the destination

Routes, accommodation and group arrangements should account for local laws, customs, residents, wildlife, other road users and environmental impact. The destination is not a backdrop.

Standard Four — Preparation Standards

Preparation is a shared process and an individual responsibility.

We welcome people at every stage, including riders who have only recently learned. Inexperience isn't a barrier — it's the start of an honest conversation about preparation, route options and the support someone needs to take part safely.

The community provides clear information, reasonable guidance and chances to build skills. Each rider is responsible for using them and preparing for the level of participation they've chosen.

Understand the ride

Get familiar with the distances, climbing, terrain, likely weather, daily structure, support and limitations before departure. Prepare for the actual demands of the journey, not an assumption based on distance alone.

Physical preparation

Prepare from your own starting point for your intended level of participation. An experienced rider may be building endurance and back-to-back days. A newer rider may be starting with confidence, bike handling, braking, riding in light traffic and gradually increasing distance.

Not everyone needs to prepare for the full route. Where the ride offers shorter stages, flatter sections, supported groups or vehicle transfers, prepare specifically for the option you intend to take. The aim isn't to make every rider equally capable — it's for each to be genuinely ready for the ride they're planning to do.

Practical skills

Newer riders may want support with:

- Basic bike control
- Starting, stopping and braking safely
- Changing gear
- Riding alongside other cyclists
- Traffic awareness and road position
- Simple navigation
- Managing clothing, hydration and food
- Knowing when to stop or ask for help

More experienced riders are expected to manage navigation, routine mechanical problems and greater independence. Nobody needs to be an expert before they're welcome — but everyone should engage honestly with the practice their chosen route requires.

Progressive participation

A first trip might mean shorter distances, selected stages or extra support, with longer routes coming as confidence grows. Taking a shorter option or travelling in a support vehicle is a legitimate way in, not a lesser one. Progress should be encouraged and never forced.

Bike and equipment readiness

Your bike and essential kit must be suitable, working and maintained. Check early enough that faults, parts or fitting problems can actually be fixed before departure. Test new equipment before the ride rather than discovering it on day one — a new saddle at kilometre thirty is nobody's friend.

Each Trip Guide should distinguish clearly between:

- Essential equipment
- Strongly recommended equipment
- Optional personal choices

Preparation isn't measured by how much you carry, but by whether you have what the conditions reasonably demand.

E-bikes

E-bikes are welcome on every ride.

They bring people into the community who would otherwise be shut out by fitness, age, injury, or the simple fact that two people who want to travel together ride at different speeds. That is exactly what this Framework is for.

Riding one carries a few specific responsibilities:

- **Range is yours to manage.** Know your realistic range against the day's climbing and temperature, and plan your charging. Support can't carry a charger for everyone or divert to recover a flat battery that was entirely foreseeable.
- **Say so when you book.** Accommodation needs asking about charging points, and that's a planning task, not a day-one surprise.
- **Batteries are the constraint, not the bike.** Most e-bike batteries are far above the limit airlines permit in any baggage, and carriage by ferry and by road has its own rules. How the batteries travel is settled at planning stage for any trip involving a flight, a ferry or the lorry.
- **Mechanical support may not stretch to the motor.** Drive systems are proprietary and roadside repair often isn't possible. A motor failure may simply mean the van.
- **Legal class matters.** Standard pedelecs — assistance to 25 km/h — are treated as bicycles across the UK and EU. Speed pedelecs assisting to 45 km/h are legally mopeds in most countries, requiring registration, insurance and a licence. Those are not suitable for our trips.

An e-bike changes the effort, not the Charter. Same preparation, same self-sufficiency, same not-a-race.

Health and personal readiness

Consider your physical health, mental wellbeing, medication and personal circumstances. Get medical advice where you need it, carry enough prescribed medication, and raise relevant concerns through the arrangements for the ride. Rest and recovery before travel count too — arriving exhausted affects more than just you.

Insurance, travel and documentation

Arranging insurance, documents and permissions is the rider's responsibility. Depending on the ride this may include travel and cycling insurance, passport,

visas, health documentation, medication letters, permits and emergency contacts.

Make sure cover reflects the destination, the activity and your level of participation, including medical treatment, emergency assistance and repatriation where relevant. The community can offer guidance; choosing suitable cover and keeping documents valid stays with you.

Preparation support

We try to make preparation achievable, particularly for newer riders. Depending on the trip this may include beginner-friendly training rides, bike handling practice, gradual distance building, navigation demonstrations, kit guidance, route and safety briefings, pairing newer riders with supportive experienced ones, and clear advice on which stages suit whom.

It also means questions can be asked without embarrassment. The purpose isn't to test whether someone already belongs. It's to help them be ready.

Developing people

Preparation is where the community gets stronger. Experienced riders are encouraged to share knowledge, support newcomers and help with training or briefings. Teaching sharpens the person teaching as much as it helps the person learning.

Riders who show reliability, sound judgement and a willingness to help should be encouraged into more responsibility — helping on a training ride, supporting a briefing, checking a route, mentoring someone new. That's how future coordinators and organisers appear, and it works better than appointment.

Standard Five — Operational Standards

A well-run day feels flexible without becoming uncertain.

A clear daily structure

Everyone should know:

- The planned start time
- The route and available options
- Meeting or collection points
- Any cut-off times
- Finish arrangements
- How to contact the support team
- What to do if their plans change

Simple enough to hold in your head, flexible enough to survive the day.

Briefings

Where appropriate, a short briefing before each stage covering what matters that day: significant route features, weather, road conditions, navigation, support arrangements and any changes to the published plan.

Briefings shouldn't re-read everything already sent. Their purpose is shared awareness, not transferring responsibility for every decision to whoever is holding the map.

Freedom to ride differently

Ride at a pace that suits you, take the route option that fits your ability, stop for photographs, visit what interests you, use vehicle support where it's part of the design.

That freedom depends on staying inside the operational framework: follow the designated route or an agreed alternative, stay contactable, and communicate any decision affecting collection, accommodation, luggage, meals or support.

Navigation and accountability

Use the navigation arrangements specified for the ride. Don't rely on following another rider — groups separate, and the person ahead may not be on the correct route either.

Know where you're expected to go and how to make contact if you're lost, delayed or unable to continue. Those running the ride need a reasonable way of establishing that people have completed the stage or reached the agreed place. That's reassurance, not surveillance.

Managing a spread-out ride

Riders at different speeds will end up a long way apart. That's the natural consequence of letting people ride their own day, and it puts real pressure on a small support team. Support should be designed around the likely spread of the group, not around the fiction that one vehicle can stay near everyone.

Support cannot provide continuous supervision, a personal escort, or immediate recovery across an extended route.

If you're riding independently, be equipped to:

- Follow the agreed route
- Manage routine navigation
- Carry essential food, water, clothing and repair items
- Deal with minor difficulties
- Communicate your location clearly
- Wait safely if assistance is coming

Where it helps, a ride may use agreed route options, riding groups, meeting points, support zones, cut-off times or regrouping locations to keep support workable.

Support is directed according to need, risk and the wellbeing of the wider group. It won't always arrive immediately, or in the order requests came in. Freedom to ride independently depends on being able to look after yourself between points of support.

Use of support

Support vehicles and crew assist with illness, injury, significant mechanical failure, planned transfers, changes to participation, and situations a rider can't reasonably manage alone. They are not a following car, a taxi, or a recovery service for every inconvenience.

When you need help, say so clearly, give an accurate location and follow the collection arrangements you're given. Those providing support are balancing requests across the whole route, so their decisions carry — particularly when several people need help at once.

Communication during the ride

There should be one clear channel for essential information, and everyone should know which it is, who to contact and what to say when reporting a problem or a change of plan. Messages affecting safety, transport or group arrangements should be acknowledged. Keep operational traffic separate enough that it doesn't drown in the day's photographs.

Where mobile coverage is unreliable, alternative arrangements should be agreed in advance.

Adapting the day

Weather, road conditions, delays, fatigue or local circumstances may change the plan. Those making the call should weigh the information available, the wellbeing of riders and the consequences for everyone else, then communicate the change clearly and as early as they can.

Adaptation is not evidence of failed planning. It's usually evidence of sound judgement.

Riders, non-riders and the shared experience

Where a ride includes non-riders or people on different routes, the day should still create chances to reconnect — at places of interest, meals, accommodation or shared activities. Not everyone follows the same programme, but the arrangements shouldn't quietly produce two separate holidays.

Starting and ending the day well

Be ready at the agreed time with the kit and information you need. Avoid delays that hold up the group.

At the end of the day there should be a simple way of confirming people have arrived or completed their plan, and anything significant for tomorrow should

be flagged. Then let the day close. Not everything needs a formal review — rest and enjoyment are part of the trip too.

Standard Six — Safety Standards

Trip involves uncertainty and risk. The purpose of safety planning isn't to remove challenge; it's to identify foreseeable risks, reduce avoidable harm, and make sure people can respond sensibly when things change.

Safety is shared. Those planning provide the framework. Every rider stays responsible for their own decisions, conduct and wellbeing.

Proportionate risk management

Safety arrangements should match the ride. A day on familiar roads needs different precautions from a remote mountain crossing. Consider route, traffic, terrain, weather, altitude, remoteness, communication coverage and access to emergency help. The aim isn't bureaucracy — it's giving genuine thought to what could materially go wrong and taking sensible steps.

Honest information

Riders should know the significant risks and limitations before deciding to join. Don't understate difficulty, and don't offer reassurance where real uncertainty exists. Be explicit that support may be limited by distance, terrain, coverage or the number of people needing help at once.

Individual responsibility

Ride within your ability. Use the required safety equipment, follow local road rules, and stay alert to traffic, surfaces, weather and hazards. The presence of organisers, volunteers or a support vehicle does not transfer responsibility for your safety to somebody else.

Support can reduce risk. It cannot replace judgement.

Health, fatigue and wellbeing

Pay attention to illness, injury, pain, hydration, food, temperature and fatigue, and raise concerns early rather than concealing them until they become emergencies. Anyone unwell, exhausted or unable to continue safely should be supported in changing or ending their day. Nobody should feel pressured onward by pride, group expectation or fear of being a nuisance.

Stopping is often the safest and most responsible decision available.

Safe cycling conduct

Ride in a manner appropriate to the road, terrain, traffic and conditions — keeping control, leaving stopping distance, and avoiding anything that creates unnecessary risk for yourself or others. Particular care is needed when:

- Descending
- Riding in traffic
- Approaching junctions
- Cycling in poor visibility
- Riding on unfamiliar or damaged surfaces
- Overtaking or riding closely with others
- Stopping at the roadside
- Rejoining the route after a pause

Riding together doesn't outsource your judgement. Each rider watches for hazards and makes their own decisions.

Equipment and bike safety

Your bike and essential equipment must be suitable and working. Each Trip Guide should identify required safety equipment clearly — helmets, lights, reflective items, navigation devices, communication kit or clothing appropriate to conditions. Address mechanical concerns before departure. Mechanical support during a ride doesn't replace arriving on a properly maintained bike.

Weather and conditions

Conditions should be monitored throughout. Heat, cold, rain, wind, storms, poor visibility, altitude or deteriorating roads may require changes to the route, start time, distance or method of participation. Carry the clothing and protection specified, and act promptly when conditions start affecting you.

Completing the published route never takes priority over sound judgement.

Communication and location

Know how to reach the support team or emergency services and how to describe your location accurately. Where coverage is unreliable, understand the alternative arrangements. A rider who is lost, delayed or unable to continue should make contact as soon as possible and stay somewhere safe.

Navigation devices and tracking tools support safety. None of them should create an expectation of continuous monitoring.

Incidents and emergencies

Every ride needs a clear, proportionate approach. Those involved should understand:

- Who coordinates the response — normally the Ride Coordinator, or the Deputy in their absence
- How emergency assistance is contacted
- How health and emergency information can be accessed
- How the rest of the group will be managed

- How significant incidents are recorded and reviewed

In an emergency, the safety and wellbeing of those involved comes first. Schedules, logistics and finishing the route are secondary.

Authority to change the plan

The Ride Coordinator may change, shorten, delay or cancel any part of the planned activity when conditions create an unacceptable level of risk, and may restrict or end an individual's participation where there is an immediate safety concern. The Deputy holds the same authority whenever the Coordinator is unavailable, and in any matter concerning the Coordinator personally.

Such decisions should be proportionate, clearly communicated, and based on the best information available at the time. Riders are expected to respect them, even when disappointed by them.

Organisational insurance

The community maintains organisers' liability insurance through affiliation to a national cycling body. That cover protects those acting in recognised organising, leadership or volunteer roles against claims arising from the performance of those responsibilities.

Three conditions follow from it, and they are obligations rather than administrative details:

- **Named volunteers must be registered.** Ride Coordinators, Deputies, ride leaders and volunteers are covered only if registered with the affiliating body. Registration must be current before a trip departs.
- **No competitive events.** Cover excludes racing, time trials and mass-start competition. Our trips are not races, which is a value in Standard One and a condition of insurance here.
- **Scope must be confirmed for each destination.** Cover is not universal — the current policy excludes certain territories, and overseas trips should be checked against it during planning.

Organisational insurance does not replace each rider's own travel, medical, repatriation, cycling and third-party liability cover. Nor does its existence remove the need for careful planning, proportionate risk management and clear responsibilities.

The safety standard

A safe trip isn't one where nothing unexpected happens. It's one where risks were considered honestly, riders stayed responsible, and change was met with judgement.

The destination matters. Getting home matters more.

Standard Seven — Behaviour Standards

The character of a trip is shaped as much by how people behave as by the route they ride. These standards apply throughout — travel, accommodation, meals, social evenings, the bike, and communication before and after the trip.

Respect and courtesy

Everyone involved is treated with courtesy, patience and dignity: fellow riders, volunteers, support crew, professional providers, accommodation staff, drivers, guides, and the people whose towns we ride through.

Experience, speed, ability or organisational responsibility gives nobody the right to dismiss, belittle or humiliate anyone. That matters most when people are tired, disappointed or under pressure — which is exactly when it's hardest.

Inclusion and belonging

People should feel valued regardless of cycling ability, experience, background, age, identity or how much of the ride they do. Different distances and different levels of support don't create a hierarchy of worth.

Encouragement, humour and friendly challenge are part of the fun. Behaviour that excludes, intimidates or repeatedly undermines someone isn't.

Conduct under pressure

Raise concerns calmly and, where possible, directly with the person concerned. Argue with the problem, not the person. Shouting, threats, bullying, discriminatory conduct and deliberate humiliation are unacceptable. When tempers are up, pausing the conversation and returning to it later is usually the better move.

Respect for volunteers and support crew

They give their time and goodwill to make the trip happen. They are not personal servants and cannot drop everything for every request. Ask courteously, and accept operational decisions when resources are being balanced across the whole group.

Equally, those in leadership or support roles should communicate respectfully rather than using the position to be controlling or dismissive. Responsibility works in both directions.

Alcohol and other substances

Riders are responsible for ensuring nothing impairs their judgement, behaviour or ability to take part safely. No one cycles, drives, performs a support role or makes a safety-critical decision while impaired. Social enjoyment is part of most trips; it shouldn't create risk, distress or unreasonable disruption for anyone else. Where substance use materially affects safety or behaviour, participation may need to be restricted or ended.

Privacy, photography and social media

Photographs and stories are part of community life, but respect people's privacy, dignity and preferences when taking or sharing them. Take particular care where someone is injured, distressed, receiving medical attention or simply having an undignified moment. Don't share content that humiliates a rider, misrepresents the trip or disrespects local people. Where someone has asked not to be photographed or identified, that stands.

Images of riders under 18 are not shared publicly without the explicit agreement of a parent. This is a higher bar than applies to adults, and it applies to everyone taking photographs, not only to whoever runs the community's channels.

Respect for local communities

We are guests. Observe local laws, customs, religious practices and expectations of dress and conduct. People, homes, places of worship and cultural traditions are not scenery. Approach language barriers and cultural differences with patience and good humour.

Raising concerns

Anyone should be able to raise a concern about behaviour without fear of ridicule or retaliation. Minor difficulties are usually best dealt with early and informally.

More serious concerns go to the Ride Coordinator. Where the concern is about the Coordinator, it goes instead to the Deputy, or to the second named contact identified in the Trip Guide for exactly this purpose. Both names appear in every Trip Guide before departure.

Responses should be proportionate, focused on protecting individuals and restoring respectful behaviour. Serious or repeated misconduct may lead to restrictions, removal from an activity, or an end to participation, decided as set out in Standard Two.

The behaviour standard

Good behaviour isn't the absence of conflict. It's the active creation of a culture where people feel respected and able to belong.

The standard is straightforward: enjoy the trip fully, while protecting the dignity, safety and enjoyment of everyone else.

Standard Eight — Continuous Improvement

Every trip creates experience, and it shouldn't end when the ride does.

Continuous improvement doesn't mean hunting for faults or making every ride identical. It means learning honestly from what happened, keeping what worked, and changing what needs it.

Reflection after every trip

Formal or informal depending on the trip, the purpose is to understand:

- What worked particularly well
- What created difficulty or avoidable pressure
- Whether people got the information they needed
- Whether the route, support and daily arrangements were realistic
- What to preserve, change or explore further

Look at the whole experience, not just the cycling. Travel, accommodation, communication, inclusion, group dynamics and cultural moments all teach something.

Feedback from different perspectives

Welcome it from riders, non-riders, volunteers and support crew. People experience the same journey very differently, and the quieter perspectives often reveal what the organisers couldn't see. Provide a private or anonymous route for anyone who wants one.

Encourage feedback without implying every preference produces a change. The purpose is to find meaningful patterns, not to collect opinions.

Constructive and responsible feedback

Good feedback is specific, respectful and aimed at improvement. It helps to distinguish between:

- A genuine concern
- A personal preference
- An unavoidable difficulty
- A failure of preparation or communication
- Something nobody could reasonably have predicted

Those receiving feedback should listen without getting defensive. Those giving it should remember the voluntary effort behind the trip. Honesty and appreciation can coexist.

Learning without blame

Mistakes, near misses and difficult experiences should be examined to understand what can be learned — what happened, what influenced it, and whether planning, preparation, communication, support or decision-making could be stronger.

This doesn't mean responsibility is ignored. Where conduct or repeated failure to meet agreed expectations contributed materially, say so honestly and address it fairly. A learning culture combines accountability with proportion.

Preserving what works

Improvement isn't only change. Successful practices and traditions deserve recognition and protection. A new approach shouldn't replace a working one just because it's new. Change needs a purpose.

The aim is thoughtful evolution, not continual reinvention.

Sharing knowledge

Lessons should be recorded where future organisers can find them:

- Updated route information
- Improved participant guidance
- Refined equipment and preparation advice
- Reliable providers and local knowledge
- Recurring risks and logistical headaches
- Decisions and the reasoning behind them

Knowledge sitting in one person's memory is a single point of failure. Writing it down stops the community solving the same problem every year and reduces its dependence on any individual organiser.

Turning learning into change

Not every suggestion needs acting on. Weigh proposals against the purpose, ethos, values and practical needs of the community. Where a change is agreed, be clear about:

- What is changing
- Why
- Who is responsible
- Whether it applies to all rides or particular ones
- How its effect will be reviewed

Developing people

Improvement applies to people as much as systems. Newer riders become more self-sufficient, experienced ones become mentors, volunteers become organisers and stewards. Create opportunities for people to contribute to their strengths and to take on responsibilities that stretch them sensibly.

A stronger community comes from more capable and generous people, not just better plans.

Stewardship and continuity

Every generation of riders inherits the experience of the last, and owes the next one better knowledge, stronger practice and a healthy culture. The point of all this is continuity: making sure the community can learn and adapt as people, destinations and circumstances change, rather than depending indefinitely on its founders.

Every trip should leave behind more than photographs. It should leave the next one better prepared.

Part IV — The Trip Guide

Purpose

Every trip is accompanied by an Trip Guide.

The Framework holds what stays true from one journey to the next. The Trip Guide holds what is true of one journey only: the route, the dates, the costs, the kit, and the names of the people responsible. Between them they should answer every reasonable question a rider has before departure.

The Guide is written for the rider, not for the organiser's records. If a section can't be read quickly by someone deciding whether to come, it needs rewriting.

What every Trip Guide must contain

Trip summary

What this journey is for, where it goes, how long it lasts, and the character of the riding. Enough for someone to know within a page whether it's their kind of trip.

Named responsibilities

The **Ride Coordinator** and the **Deputy**, named, with contact details. A **second named contact** for concerns about the Coordinator. Who holds routes, transport, accommodation, finances and support arrangements.

This section is not optional and cannot be filled in later. Several standards in Part III depend on these names existing before departure.

Daily itinerary

Stage by stage: distance, climbing, terrain, surface, likely conditions, start and finish points, cut-off times where they apply, and the shorter or alternative options available on each day.

Participation information

The levels of participation available, including non-riding options. What each requires by way of fitness and experience. Arrangements for riders under 18. How to discuss suitability, and with whom.

Equipment requirements

Separated clearly into essential, strongly recommended, and personal choice. Required safety equipment identified as such. Any e-bike arrangements, including charging and battery transport.

Travel information

How riders reach the start and leave the finish, and what they arrange themselves. Bike transport arrangements. Documentation needed for the destination, including consent letters for young riders travelling without both parents.

Navigation

The system the trip runs on, how routes are distributed, and what riders are expected to have loaded and working before day one.

Support arrangements

What support exists, what it covers, and — just as importantly — what it does not. Where support zones and meeting points fall. How to request assistance and what to say when doing so.

Safety information

Significant risks and limitations, stated honestly. Emergency contacts and procedure. How health and emergency information is held for this trip and when it is destroyed. Local emergency numbers and the nearest medical facilities along the route.

Financial information

The expected cost and what it includes. Deposit, interim payments and final balance, with timing. The administration fee and its charitable destination. Withdrawal and cancellation terms. The statement that the trip sits outside the Package Travel Regulations, and what that means for the rider.

Communications

The channel for essential information, who to contact, and what to expect by way of response. Arrangements where coverage is unreliable.

Local information

Customs, laws, expectations of conduct and dress, road rules, and anything a visitor genuinely needs to know in order to be a good guest.

Principles for Trip Guides

- Reflect the Charter, not merely reference it.
- Be accurate, clear and proportionate — sufficiency rather than volume.
- Distinguish plainly between what is required and what is advice.
- Support informed decisions and personal responsibility.
- Mark provisional information as provisional.
- Be checked by someone other than the author before it is issued.

An Trip Guide should prepare riders for the journey without burying them. It should give them what they need to travel confidently, participate responsibly and enjoy themselves — and nothing they will never read.

Part V — Governance and Stewardship

What WRhinos Is

WRhinos is an unincorporated association, governed by a written constitution agreed by its members and affiliated to a national cycling body.

The name is older than the ambitions. It began as an affectionate nickname — the whining rhinos, forever grumbling about hills and headwinds before getting on with it — and it has been earned rather than chosen ever since. We write it WRhinos where a form objects to punctuation, and Birmingham W/Rhinos when we are among friends. A community that can laugh at itself tends to be one worth joining.

That structure exists for practical reasons rather than ceremonial ones. It allows the community to hold funds in its own name, to obtain organisers' liability insurance for those who volunteer, to define who its members are, and to make decisions that survive the departure of any individual.

It also has a limit worth stating plainly: an unincorporated association is not a separate legal person, so those who serve on its committee retain personal responsibility for what is done in its name. That is a reason for care, not a reason for timidity — and a reason the roles below are defined rather than assumed.

Roles

The Committee

The members elect a committee to hold the community's affairs between trips: its funds, its insurance, its records, and the Framework itself. The committee's composition, election and meetings are set out in the constitution rather than here.

The Ride Coordinator

Each trip has a Ride Coordinator, named in its Trip Guide, who holds operational authority for that journey: the decisions described in Standard Six, the health and emergency information described in Standard Two, and overall responsibility for the running of the trip.

The Deputy

Each trip also has a named Deputy, who holds the same authority whenever the Coordinator is unavailable, and in any matter concerning the Coordinator personally. The Deputy is not a spare part; the role exists precisely so that no decision, and no complaint, depends on a single individual being both available and disinterested.

Funding of trips

The community may authorise a member to fund trip expenditure by personal means in advance of receipts from riders. Such expenditure is reimbursed at cost from the community's account against invoices, approved by a signatory other than the person reimbursed. Any loyalty or reward benefits arising accrue to the funding member, in recognition of the financial risk carried on the community's behalf.

This arrangement is recorded in the accounts and disclosed to riders in every Trip Guide. It works because it is visible.

Stewardship

The Framework belongs to the community, not to any individual. Those entrusted with organising trips apply its principles and protect the values it rests on.

No one owns this. Everyone passing through it is a custodian of something meant to outlast them.

Review and Improvement

The Framework is reviewed periodically in the light of experience, rider feedback and changing good practice. Changes are made thoughtfully, and only where they strengthen it without compromising its principles.

Amendments to Parts I and II — the Spirit and the Charter — should be rare, and agreed by the members. Parts III to V will need more regular attention as circumstances, destinations and obligations change.

Two matters carry review dates of their own: insurance scope, which must be confirmed against each destination during planning, and the regulatory position described under Money in Standard Three, which is expected to change and should be reviewed before it does.

Leadership and Succession

The community's long-term health depends on developing organisers rather than relying on them. Every trip should give somebody their first taste of responsibility, and every experienced organiser should be working towards being unnecessary.

The Framework exists to support that continuity — to ensure the community remains strong regardless of who happens to be leading a given journey.

Closing

This Framework is more than a guide to organising trips. It is a statement of the kind of community we want to be.

It exists to encourage curiosity, personal responsibility, mutual support, and respect for the people and places we encounter. No document replaces good judgement, kindness or common sense, and this one shouldn't be asked to.

If it helps create trips that are safe, welcoming, challenging and memorable — and leaves those who come after us a community stronger than the one we inherited — it will have done its job.

Freedom through Responsibility. Adventure through Community.